understanding of what he stood for? Some answers are readily available for those who care to look.

Bhagat Singh's slogan of 'Long live the Revolution' was drawn from other world revolutionaries before him. In a riposte to Ramanand Chatterji, the editor of *Modern Review*, that the phrase was pointless as it perpetuated the notion of endless agitation, Bhagat Singh and B.K. Dutt gave an explanation which was published in the *Tribune* on 24 December 1929, saying, 'We are not the originators of this cry.' This was because 'the same cry had been used in Russian Revolutionary movements'. However, Bhagat Singh had a far better sense of the development of the term, pointing out that '[t]he sense in which the word Revolution is used in that phrase, is the spirit, the longing for a change for the better'. This is because '[t]he people generally get accustomed to the established order of things and begin to tremble at the very idea of change', but that '[i]t is this lethargical spirit that needs to be replaced by the revolutionary spirit'. It is in this sense that '[t]he spirit of Revolution should always permeate the soul of humanity, so that the reactionary forces may not accumulate strength to check its eternal onward march'. In this way, the '[o]ld order should change, always and ever, yielding place to new, so that one "good" order may not corrupt the world'. This confirms what was said two months earlier on 19 October 1929, when Subhas Chandra Bose opened the Second Punjab Students' Conference in Lahore. He opened it with a signed statement from Bhagat Singh and B.K. Dutt, which he read out in the opening session. This proclaimed, 'Today, we cannot ask the youth to take pistols and bombs.' It clearly demonstrated Bhagat Singh's opposition to violence for its own sake. He reposed his faith rather in the fact that '[t]he youth will have to spread this revolutionary message to the far corners of the country. They have to awaken crores of slum-dwellers of the industrial areas and villagers living in worn-out cottages, so that we will be independent and the exploitation of man by man will become an impossibility'. Not surprisingly, Shiv Verma, who was at the meeting, noted how the opening address was met with 'a thunderous applause' accompanied by 'slogans of Bhagat Singh Zindabad'.[24]